

the basic
argument



allowable
evils

A large, solid orange circle serves as the background for the text.

what is
omnipotence?

the
argument
reformulated

What do we mean by 'evil'?

For our purposes, an evil is just some feature of the world that the world would be (everything else equal) better off without.

So defined, it seems very plausible that there are many evils, some large and some small. The Holocaust is a massive evil; your roommate being rude to you this morning is a small one.

It seems plausible both that we can recognize that some things are evils in this sense, and that we can sometimes see that one evil is worse than another.

At this point, you might be inclined to object: don't people have different definitions of 'evil' and disagree about what things are evil?

Sure. But notice that you don't have to be able to define something, or resolve every disagreement about something, to recognize some instances of a kind.

Consider the kind 'chair.' It is hard to come up with a good definition of this word, and there are some cases where there might be disagreement over whether something is a chair. But that doesn't mean that we can never confidently recognize something to be a chair.

Here is a different objection that people sometimes give to the existence of evil, which might be called the 'sliding scale' objection:

What we call 'evil' is relative. If you took away something which seems bad to us — like the Holocaust — we would just regard other things as more evil, since there would be less bad things. And if we took away everything which we now think of as evil, we would just regard other things, which we now think of as minor annoyances, as evil.

For our purposes, an evil is just some feature of the

equal) better off without.

world that the world would be (everything else

So defined, it seems very plausible that there are many evils,



some large and some small. The Holocaust is a massive evil;

your mate being rude to you this morning is a small one.

things are evils in this sense, and that we can sometimes see

that one evil is worse than another.

It seems plausible both that we can recognize that some

things are even?

At this point, you might be inclined to object: don't people

have different definitions of 'evil' and disagree about what

Sure. But notice that you don't have to be able to define

recognize someone instances of a kind.

something, or resolve everything, to

something to be a chair.

that doesn't mean that we can never confidently recognize

Consider the kind 'chair.' It is hard to come up with a good

definition of this word, and there are cases where there

might disagree on whether something is a chair. But

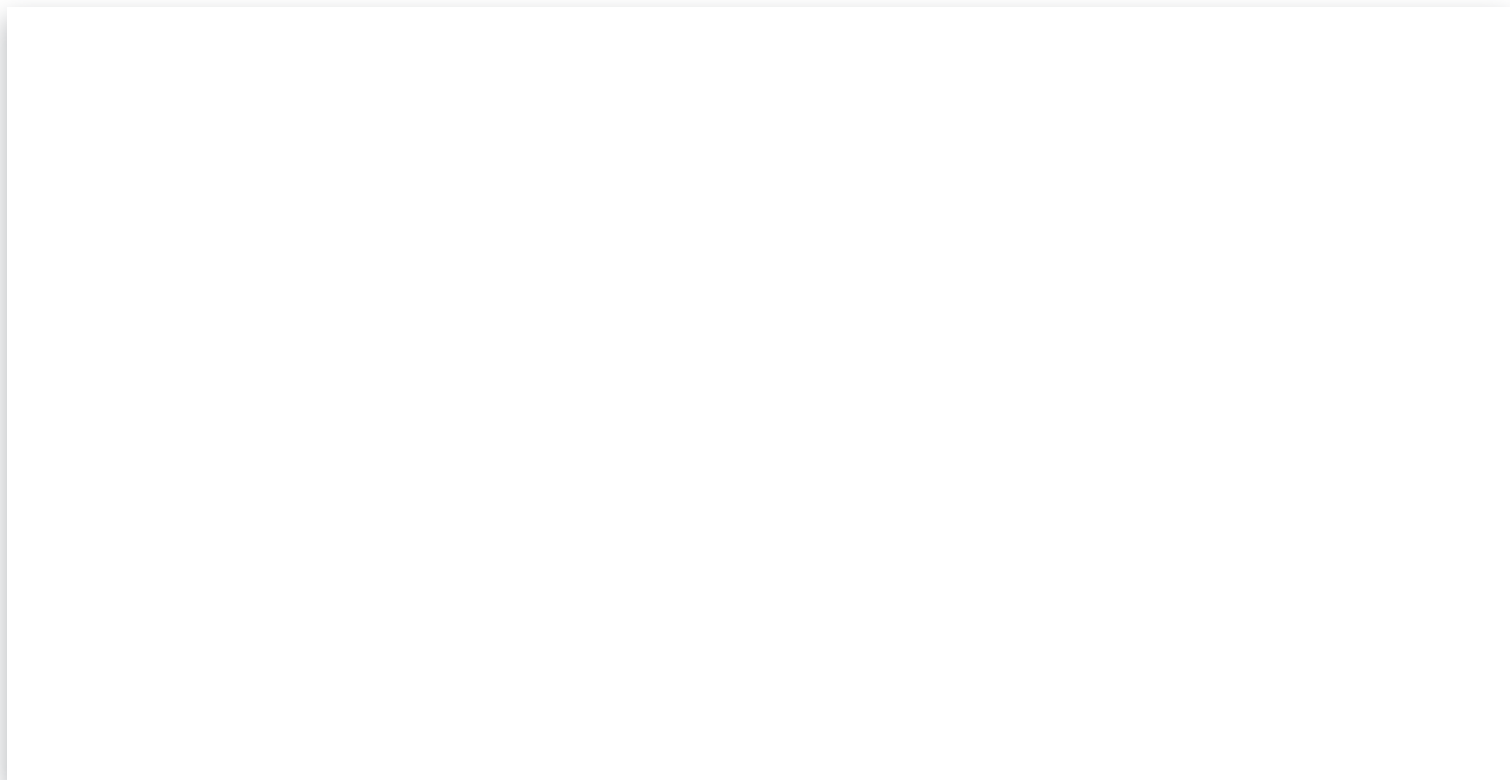
scale's objective:

the existence of evil, which

nightbedthe'sliding

Here is a different objection

that people sometimes give to



something which seems bad to us — like the

things, which we now think of as minor

and/or articles, as well.

What we call 'evil' is relative. If you took away

Holocaust — we would just regard other things

now think of as evil, we would just regard other

things. And if we took away everything which we

as more evil, since there would be less bad

There are two especially important arguments against belief in God.



is important, it

2: If something

any possible



cairibiriing about

the 1990s, the number of people with a mental health problem has increased by 50% (Mental Health Foundation 2000).

There is a growing awareness of the need to address the needs of people with mental health problems, and a number of initiatives have been developed to improve the lives of people with mental health problems. The Mental Health Act 1983 was amended in 1997 to give people with mental health problems more control over their own lives. The Mental Health Act 1997 was introduced to give people with mental health problems more control over their own lives. The Mental Health Act 1997 was introduced to give people with mental health problems more control over their own lives.

The Mental Health Act 1997 was introduced to give people with mental health problems more control over their own lives. The Mental Health Act 1997 was introduced to give people with mental health problems more control over their own lives. The Mental Health Act 1997 was introduced to give people with mental health problems more control over their own lives.

The Mental Health Act 1997 was introduced to give people with mental health problems more control over their own lives. The Mental Health Act 1997 was introduced to give people with mental health problems more control over their own lives. The Mental Health Act 1997 was introduced to give people with mental health problems more control over their own lives.

The Mental Health Act 1997 was introduced to give people with mental health problems more control over their own lives. The Mental Health Act 1997 was introduced to give people with mental health problems more control over their own lives. The Mental Health Act 1997 was introduced to give people with mental health problems more control over their own lives.

The Mental Health Act 1997 was introduced to give people with mental health problems more control over their own lives. The Mental Health Act 1997 was introduced to give people with mental health problems more control over their own lives. The Mental Health Act 1997 was introduced to give people with mental health problems more control over their own lives.

The Mental Health Act 1997 was introduced to give people with mental health problems more control over their own lives. The Mental Health Act 1997 was introduced to give people with mental health problems more control over their own lives. The Mental Health Act 1997 was introduced to give people with mental health problems more control over their own lives.

The Mental Health Act 1997 was introduced to give people with mental health problems more control over their own lives. The Mental Health Act 1997 was introduced to give people with mental health problems more control over their own lives. The Mental Health Act 1997 was introduced to give people with mental health problems more control over their own lives.

it always initiates as much

6. If God exists, then God

elinitates nich printess

evil as God said. (4,5)

no point less evi1. (7)



(3,6)

9*. Some principles exist.

2. If something is on it,

7. If God exists, then God

5*. If something is wholly good,

it can do anything.

3. If God exists, then God can

wholly good.

prints even as it can.

1. If God exists, then God is

elinites all point less vii.

8. If God exists, then there is

do anything. (1,2)



4. If God exists, then God is

C. God does not exist. (8,9)



the basic
argument

**allowable
evils**

what is
omnipotence?

the
argument
reformulated

So attention naturally focuses on premise (5).



good, it always reminds

5. If something is wholly

as in every other case.



**allowable
evils**



9*. Some points less

evildoers.

A large, solid orange circle serves as the background for the text.

**what is
omnipotence?**



What we call 'evil' is relative. If you took away something which seems bad to us — like the Holocaust — we would just regard other things as more evil, since there would be less bad things. And if we took away everything which we now think of as evil, we would just regard other things, which we now think of as minor annoyances, as evil.

What we call 'evil' is relative. If you took away something which seems bad to us — like the Holocaust — we would just regard other things as more evil, since there would be less bad things. And if we took away everything which we now think of as evil, we would just regard other things, which we now think of as minor annoyances, as evil.